CART 444 WINTER 2026

TASK-TWO:
Design Manifesto

TASK-TWO DESCRIPTION:

"Karl Marx had one. The Unibomber had one. When Thomas Jefferson wrote the Declaration of Independence in 1776, he drafted the manifesto that launched the American Revolution. Graphic design would not exist as we know it today if F. T. Marinetti hadn't published his manifestos and instigated Futurism…"

Manifesto Mania describes the widespread, often frenzied, creation of manifestos across artistic, political, and corporate fields to declare, justify, or challenge conventions over the course of the 20th Century. These documents, manifestos or creeds, served as public declarations of intent, such as in graphic design (Futurism), technology, and personal philosophy.

Following in this long tradition, you will create a **Zine Design Manifesto** that articulates, provides clarity and direction with regards to your vision in the role of artist and your creative digital practice.

Design manifestos often start by addressing a problem or concern - an assertion. And they often end with a call to action; the author may layout principles or tenets to guide designers to their vision of a better designer or better world. Regardless of its format (list, essay, imagery), the document serves a greater community: it offers clarity and direction for oneself and other designers to rally around.

TASK-TWO OBJECTIVES

- Define a personal vision and goals for your work as an artist/designer/technologist - what is your call to action (artistic | political | technological etc)?
- Consider the role of art, design, technology and designers in contemporary society

• Articulate your ideas in the form of a Zine Design Manifesto

TASK-TWO REQUIREMENTS AND DELIVERABLES

For the Zine Design Manifesto, it is encouraged to articulate your manifesto as a body of text (~150–300 words) in the form of an essay, a list, commandments, or a poem tightly coupled and supported through a (graphic, visual, textual) narrative.

Lastly, the Design Manifesto shall be collated as a zine booklet i.e. flippable or foldable form.

Consider the visual form of your zine manifesto. What typeface(s) are you using? What colours are you using? What type of card-stock and orientation is your paper? How have you chosen to bind the pages? Why?

Key characteristics for the Zine Design Manifesto:

Zine Page Count 16:

Minimum 16 Pages. Consider the different ways to fold a sheet of paper: Folio Fold (folding sheet in half), Quarto (folding sheet in quarter) etc.

A5 Size:

The **right size** is another key step in planning your zine. **Smaller sizes** are ideal for poetry zines and comic books, while larger sizes provide space for photography, illustration, or other graphic-heavy projects. Starting formats such as A3 (tabloid), A4 (letter), A5 (booklet i.e moleskin), A6 (postcard size) and A7 (business-cards) are practical because they are cost-effective and familiar to readers.

Zine Binding and Paper:

The way you bind your zine affects both its look and durability: **Saddle-stitching** (staple), **perfect binding** (heavy cover, square spine, glue and book-like feel), **spiral binding** (flexible & lies flat when open) and **Japanese Bookbinding** techniques.

Paper and Card-Stock: Satin paper (sharp vibrant colour, a smooth finish) perfect for photography zines. Uncoated paper offers a softer, tactile feel that works well

for text-focused or minimalist zines. And, for environmentally conscious creators, recycled papers provide a sustainable alternative without sacrificing print quality.

TASK-TWO DESIGN MILESTONES AND DELIVERABLES

FEBRUARY 24TH 9AM - 11:15AM (7PTS):

Zine Design Manifesto progress review session with John and myself. We will meet with each student over the course of the morning to evaluate the progress work done with regards to concretization of the Design Manifesto.

Each student is expected to present their work-in-progress zine prototype (A5 Form Factor), the manifesto text (poem, commandments), typographical and graphic elements to support manifesto, paper selection and binding commitment. A comprehensive disclosure of the design manifesto.

APRIL 7TH (8 PTS):

Submission of Design Manifesto (Physical Submission of Manifesto) along with overhead video documentation of the Design Manifesto walk-through (2 minute video).

MANIFESTOS:

Manifesto Mania
https://www.pinterest.com/museosubversivo/manifesto-mania/

Bruce Mau
https://kkrcmarik.wixsite.com/art122/bruce-mau-manifesto

Dieter Rams

https://kkrcmarik.wixsite.com/art122/dieter-rams-manifesto

Laszlo Moholy-Nagy

https://kkrcmarik.wixsite.com/art122/new-typography-manifesto

F. T. Marinetti

https://kkrcmarik.wixsite.com/art122/futurist-manifesto

Tristan Tzara

https://kkrcmarik.wixsite.com/art122/dada-manifesto

Allan Chochinov

https://kkrcmarik.wixsite.com/art122/allan-chochinov-manifesto